headers for special-purpose applications. Note that you shouldn't set cookie values in the header directly—use the cookie API to do this.

params

A hash-like object containing request parameters (along with pseudoparameters generated during routing). It's hash-like because you can index entries using either a symbol or a string—`params[:id]` and `params['id']` return the same value. Idiomatic Rails applications use the symbol form.

request

The incoming request object. It includes these attributes:

- `request_method` returns the request method, one of `:delete`, `:get`, `:head`, `:post`, or `:put`.
- `method` returns the same value as `request_method` except for `:head`, which it returns as `:get` because these two are functionally equivalent from an application point of view.
- `delete?`, `get?`, `head?`, `post?`, and `put?` return `true` or `false` based on the request method.
- `xml_http_request?` and `xhr?` return true if this request was issued by one of the Ajax helpers. Note that this parameter is independent of the `method` parameter.
- `url`, which returns the full URL used for the request.
- `protocol`, `host`, `port`, `path`, and `query_string`, which return components of the URL used for the request, based on the following pattern: `protocol://host:port/path?query_string`.
- `domain`, which returns the last two components of the domain name of the request.